THE WITNESS REMAINS - THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION, THE WITNESS AND THE DIVINE RECKONING - A PUBLIC TESTIMONY, DOCUMENTARY RECORD AND EVIDENCE INDEX OF RISE & RESURRECTION

DR RICHARD WILLIAM McLEAN — BARRAN DODGER

TRUTH DOES NOT NEED PERMISSION TO EXIST.

Lies need constant upkeep. My truth needed time. By God's grace, I am still here.

Original documentary archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

Rebuilt preservation archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

Primary GitHub evidence repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

Rebuild source repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild

Original archive index: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/index.html

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PROLOGUE — THE STORY THAT DID NOT END WITH MY DEATH

I do not need a court to tell me that I lived through my own life. I do not need a police officer, a politician, a journalist, a government department, a professional association or an institution that I believe failed me to grant permission for my testimony to exist.

I lived it.

I survived it.

I documented it.

I have preserved the correspondence, assembled the records, published my testimony and continued rebuilding a life that I believe was subjected to prolonged institutional, administrative and professional detriment.

And I am still here.

My name is Dr Richard William McLean. I am Barran Dodger. I am the person who lived

this history, the person who has spent years trying to make sense of it, and the person who refuses to allow the documentary record of my life to disappear into the filing cabinets, internal correspondence, jurisdictional boundaries and institutional explanations of other people.

I am not writing this to make powerful people comfortable.

I am writing because I believe there is a profound contradiction between the protection that institutions promise and the treatment I experienced when I needed protection most.

I am writing because I believe people entrusted with public authority, professional responsibility and the welfare of vulnerable people must confront the difference between the obligations attached to their positions and the consequences of their actions.

And I am writing because my story did not end in my death.

That is the part of this story that I believe you never anticipated.

You may have convinced yourselves that I would never recover. You may have believed that the distress, psychiatric history, poverty, isolation and circumstances through which I was struggling would permanently confine me to a version of myself that you could dismiss, manage, categorise or disregard.

You may have believed that the person you thought you knew was the whole person.

You were wrong about my potential.

You were wrong about my capacity to rebuild.

You were wrong about my determination to preserve the record.

And you were wrong if you believed that my suffering would necessarily prevent me from speaking about it.

I have described sixteen psychiatric hospitalisations across my history. I have spoken about experiences I regarded as coercive, about the consequences of treatment, about the struggle to have my concerns heard, and about the way psychiatric history can overshadow everything else a person has done, written, researched, created or experienced.

But I am more than that history.

I hold a PhD from Victoria University, awarded in 2020. I wrote *Recovered, Not Cured*, published by Allen & Unwin in 2003. I have worked as an illustrator, news graphics artist and cartoonist. I have maintained a spiritual life, continued my intellectual work and undertaken the painstaking labour of preserving a documentary archive.

My history contains mistakes and regrets. I have acknowledged those things publicly. My history also contains survival, work, creativity, faith, research, persistence and an extraordinary determination to retain my own voice.

You do not get to select only the parts of my life that make me easiest to dismiss.

You do not get to turn my distress into a permanent cage.

You do not get to define the limits of my recovery.

And you do not get to decide that because I experienced mental illness, I could never understand my own life, question the conduct of others or preserve documents that I believe deserve examination.

I believe you underestimated me because you mistook vulnerability for permanent incapacity.

I believe you mistook distress for defeat.

I believe you mistook isolation for invisibility.

And I believe you mistook the absence of an immediate public reckoning for the absence of a record.

Now the record is public.

My original archive remains accessible. A separate rebuild preserves and organises the material. My GitHub repositories provide a starting point for readers who want to explore the documentary history. My testimony brings the human consequences back into view.

The story you may have assumed would remain contained is now being told by the person who lived it.

I cannot claim that my existence, by itself, legally proves every allegation I make. But my existence does establish something you cannot wish away: the person whose future you may have underestimated is alive, speaking, rebuilding and preserving an account of what happened.

My presence is my rebuttal to the idea that I could simply be erased. My recovery challenges the assumption that my life could be permanently defined by my darkest circumstances. My archive gives my testimony a public place to stand.

I believe that combination confronts the narrative I experienced being imposed upon me.

And that is where this reckoning begins.

PART I — THE BETRAYAL OF ENTRUSTED POWER

1. What You Did to Me

What you did to me was, in my experience, an attempt to keep me below you.

I believe decisions were made that were corrupt, unethical, unlawful or inconsistent with the fiduciary, professional, humane and legal obligations attached to particular positions. I believe some of the people involved exercised authority over my life without giving sufficient consideration to the consequences for the person who would have to live with those decisions.

You held positions of privilege.

You had access to resources, institutional language, professional networks and procedures. You could write a letter, issue a decision, refer a matter, close a pathway or describe my circumstances in a way that would follow me into the next office.

I was the person who had to live with the consequences.

I believe you underestimated me. That was your greatest mistake.

I am gay, proud, freethinking, independent and spiritual. I believe in God. I believe that grace sustained me through circumstances that I found devastating. I believe that the life I have rebuilt carries a meaning that cannot be reduced to an administrative classification or another person's opinion of me.

I cannot know what every person involved thought privately. But I can describe what I experienced, the decisions and correspondence I have preserved, and why I believe the conduct documented in my archive raises serious questions about responsibility, integrity and the treatment of a vulnerable person.

I believe some people chose institutional allegiance over independent judgment. I believe some chose professional comfort over the difficult work of examining my circumstances. I believe that, at crucial points, I was treated as a problem to be managed rather than a human being whose circumstances demanded serious attention.

I experienced the consequences as civil erasure, administrative annihilation, poverty, isolation and social death.

I felt as though my life was being decided elsewhere while I was left struggling to maintain the basic conditions of survival.

I experienced the conduct of some people as cruel, dismissive and calculated. I believe certain decisions may have contributed to circumstances in which my safety and life were placed at risk. Those are serious allegations, and I preserve them as my testimony about the consequences I experienced.

When a person cannot obtain the assistance they believe they need, cannot secure stable accommodation, cannot readily access legal help and must repeatedly explain their circumstances to institutions with far greater resources, the inequality is not theoretical.

It is lived.

It is the electricity bill that still needs to be paid.

It is the telephone needed to communicate.

It is the food needed to survive.

It is the uncertainty of housing.

It is the energy consumed by another application, another referral, another explanation and another attempt to make someone understand.

I believe the cumulative consequences of my circumstances were serious. I believe that

people who occupied positions of responsibility should have considered those consequences with care.

I never gave anyone permission to harm me.

I never gave anyone permission to treat me as less than human.

I never gave anyone permission to abandon the ethical obligations attached to their position.

And I never agreed that my mistakes, my disability, my sexuality, my poverty or my psychiatric history could be used to diminish my dignity.

The evidence I have preserved is my attempt to make the history visible.

The archive begins here:

Original documentary archive — https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

Primary evidence repository — https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

2. I Am a Sinner, But I Am Not Your Scapegoat

I am a sinner.

That is right. I said it.

I have made mistakes. I have regrets. I have things in my past that I have had to confront. I have written about my own failings, acknowledged them and tried to make peace with the person I have been and the person I am becoming.

I have looked at the darkest parts of myself rather than pretend they never existed.

But my mistakes do not give you permission to mistreat me.

My poverty does not cancel my dignity.

My disability does not cancel my voice.

My vulnerability does not cancel my rights.

My sexuality does not make me less human.

My faith does not make me incapable of critical thought.

My psychiatric history does not make every statement I make automatically unworthy of consideration.

And my survival does not make your conduct acceptable.

I believe I was repeatedly confronted with assumptions about who I was, what I understood and what I was capable of doing. I believe those assumptions sometimes stood in the way of meaningful engagement with my actual circumstances and the material I was trying to communicate.

I cannot speak for every person's private motives. But I can tell you what it felt like to be treated as though my identity had already been decided and my explanations could therefore be dismissed before they were properly considered.

I confronted my demons. I walked through the fire. I made peace with things I once struggled to face.

I believe my faith helped me survive that confrontation.

I am not claiming perfection. I am claiming the right to be seen as a whole human being.

You do not get to use my worst moments as a permanent definition of my life while refusing to examine your own decisions.

You do not get to demand accountability from me while treating your own professional responsibilities as though they were optional.

You do not get to insist that I acknowledge my mistakes while refusing to consider the harm I say I experienced.

That is the hypocrisy I want exposed.

Not because I claim to be morally superior to every person who has ever dealt with me, but because I believe ethical responsibility must apply to everyone. It cannot become a weapon used against a vulnerable person and a shield used by people with institutional power.

I have done the work of confronting my past.

I am asking you to confront yours.

3. The Protection Paradox

If your position required ethical behaviour, why did I experience conduct that I believe was inconsistent with those obligations?

If you were entrusted with protecting people, why was I left feeling so unprotected?

If you were expected to exercise independent judgment, why did I experience decisions that seemed to reproduce the assumptions and limitations of the systems through which I was trying to obtain assistance?

If you were expected to act with compassion, why did I repeatedly have to explain the human consequences of decisions that affected my life?

And if you believed you were acting correctly, why should examining the correspondence, the chronology and the consequences be something to fear?

These questions are the heart of my testimony.

I believe the mechanism I experienced was the betrayal of entrusted power through institutional protection and the displacement of personal responsibility.

A person makes a decision. Another person relies on that decision. A further office refers the matter elsewhere. Each institution explains its own jurisdiction. Each process produces another document. Yet the person experiencing the consequences remains in the same circumstances, or worse.

Responsibility becomes fragmented.

The history becomes fragmented.

The human being disappears behind the process.

And everyone can point to a narrow part of the system rather than confront the cumulative effect.

That is the paradox of protection.

A system may have a policy about protecting people without the person receiving the protection they need. A complaints process may exist without resolving the concern that prompted the complaint. An institution may send a response without addressing the substance of what was raised.

I reject the assumption that the existence of a procedure proves the adequacy of its outcome.

I reject the assumption that a referral is the same as a resolution.

I reject the assumption that institutional authority makes institutional conduct immune from scrutiny.

And I reject the assumption that a vulnerable person must remain silent simply because the people they are questioning hold greater power.

I sent correspondence. I pursued processes. I tried to explain. I tried to make my circumstances understood.

I believe opportunities to acknowledge my concerns and respond constructively were missed.

I will no longer make my silence the price of other people's comfort.

PART II — THE CAGE YOU THOUGHT WOULD CONTAIN ME

4. You Never Knew My Potential

You were convinced, I believe, that I would never rise beyond the cage of mental illness, distress and adversity in which I was struggling.

That is where you were disastrously wrong.

You may have seen my distress. You may have seen my periods of instability, my difficulties and the parts of my history that were easiest to categorise.

But you did not know the whole of me.

You did not know the limits of my potential because you did not know what those limits were.

You did not know what I might become when I had time to recover, space to think, the opportunity to work and the strength to reclaim my own narrative.

You did not know what I could preserve when I stopped waiting for someone else to organise my history for me.

You did not know what I could build when I decided that my life would not be reduced to the circumstances through which I had struggled.

I believe you operated from a version of reality in which I would remain permanently diminished. I believe the assumptions embedded in that version of reality made it difficult to recognise the possibility that I could recover, develop, create, research, document and speak with renewed force.

But I am not obliged to remain the person you assumed I would be.

I have continued to write.

I have continued to research.

I have continued to organise the record.

I have preserved the website, the documents, the correspondence and the history as best I could.

I have built and rebuilt the archive.

I have continued to live.

My recovery is not a declaration that every difficulty has vanished or that every allegation has been established. It is a statement about my life: I am not permanently defined by the period in which I was most distressed.

I am more than the cage.

I am more than the label.

I am more than the worst thing that ever happened to me.

And I am more than the version of myself that other people may have found convenient

to believe.

5. My Existence Is the Rebuttal

My story did not end in my death.

Read that again.

My story did not end in my death.

I am alive.

I am writing.

I am preserving the record.

I am recovering and rebuilding.

I am placing my account where other people can read it.

I have no way of knowing what every person involved expected would happen to me. But I know that I am still here, and I know that my continued existence challenges any narrative that would reduce me to permanent helplessness, permanent incapacity or permanent silence.

My existence is not, by itself, proof of every allegation I make. The documents must be read for what they contain, and my account must be understood as my account. But my existence is an undeniable fact, and the contrast between the life I am rebuilding and the diminished future I believe others anticipated is central to my testimony.

I believe the public record exposes a contradiction that cannot be resolved by pretending I never existed.

I believe my recovery challenges the assumptions through which I felt I was being seen.

I believe the archive challenges the idea that my history could simply be contained, forgotten or reduced to a label.

And I believe the fact that I can now speak about these experiences gives me an opportunity I intend to use.

You may reject my interpretation.

You may disagree with my conclusions.

You may refuse to read a single page.

But you cannot make me disappear by refusing to acknowledge that I am here.

I am not asking you to grant me existence.

I am not asking you to approve my recovery.

I am not asking you to give me permission to speak.

I am speaking because I am alive.

And I will not apologise for surviving.

6. The Cognitive Dissonance of the Witness Who Returned

I believe that the contrast between what you assumed about me and what I have become may be deeply uncomfortable for those who held a fixed, diminished view of my capacity.

You may have believed that my distress explained everything.

You may have believed that my psychiatric history was the final word.

You may have believed that the person who struggled would always struggle, that the person who was isolated would remain isolated, and that the person who lacked resources would never assemble a public record capable of being examined by others.

But a human life does not stand still simply because another person has formed an opinion about it.

People recover.

People learn.

People change.

People discover strengths they did not know they possessed.

People revisit their histories with new understanding.

People who once struggled to explain themselves can find a language in which their experiences become intelligible.

I believe I have undergone that process.

My education, my creative work, my faith, my documentary preservation and my determination to speak are all parts of a life that cannot be understood through a single label.

If you now find yourself confronting a person whose persistence exceeds what you expected, that is a reason to reconsider your assumptions, not a reason to resent the person who survived.

I cannot know what you feel when you encounter my testimony. I cannot tell you whether you feel embarrassment, regret, anger, disbelief or nothing at all.

But I can tell you what I want you to confront.

Confront your own words.

Confront your own decisions.

Confront the documents you authored or received.

Confront the obligations attached to your position.

Confront the difference between what you believed you were doing and what the consequences were for the person on the receiving end.

And confront the possibility that you did not know me as well as you thought you did.

My life is not an experiment in your assumptions.

My recovery is not an insult to you.

My existence is not something I owe you an explanation for.

I will continue becoming whole, and I will not accept a permanent identity imposed by the period in which I suffered.

7. The Refusal to Look the Witness in the Eye

One of the most painful features of my experience has been the feeling that I could not obtain the direct, meaningful engagement I needed from people and institutions with power over important parts of my life.

I have felt dismissed. I have felt avoided. I have felt that the language of process sometimes stood between me and the human beings responsible for responding to my concerns.

I cannot claim to know the private courage, fears or motives of every person involved. But I can insist that the substance of my testimony deserves to be considered rather than avoided through labels, assumptions or procedural language.

It takes courage to examine one's own conduct.

It takes courage to admit that a decision may have caused harm.

It takes courage to reconsider an assumption.

It takes courage to say, "I may have been wrong."

And it takes courage to recognise that professional status does not make anyone immune to error.

I believe the greatest embarrassment is not that a person is questioned. It is the possibility of discovering that they failed to live up to the standard they publicly claimed to uphold.

That is the examination I am calling for.

Not public humiliation for its own sake.

Not threats.

Not revenge.

An honest confrontation with the record, the consequences and the ethical obligations

that existed at the time.

I have had to confront myself. I believe everyone who exercised responsibility in my circumstances should be willing to do the same.

PART III — THE HUMAN COST OF INSTITUTIONAL FAILURE

8. The Inequality of Our Circumstances

You had resources that I did not have.

You had institutional access, professional networks, income, accommodation and the ability to navigate procedures from within the systems in which you worked.

I was fighting for the basic conditions necessary to survive.

I have described periods of homelessness and housing insecurity, including living in my car with my therapy dog. I have experienced financial hardship, isolation and difficulty obtaining the practical assistance needed to maintain daily life.

I have had to worry about accommodation, electricity, food, communication and the ability to keep records accessible.

I have also had to devote extraordinary time and energy to preserving a documentary history while living through the circumstances that history describes.

Do you understand the absurdity of that?

I have been trying to document a complicated history involving government departments, oversight bodies, professional organisations, financial institutions, disability services, legal assistance services and healthcare institutions while also trying to maintain the basic conditions of my own existence.

I have had to become the archivist of my own experience.

I have had to organise the correspondence, retain the dates, preserve the files, identify the reference numbers, reconstruct the chronology and explain why the documents matter.

I have done this without the resources available to a government department or a large institution.

The cumulative burden matters.

Housing insecurity affects communication. Financial insecurity affects the ability to pursue assistance. Isolation makes it harder to navigate complex processes. Repeated demands to reconstruct the same history consume energy that could otherwise be devoted to rebuilding a life.

I refuse to let these consequences be fragmented until every organisation can point to its own narrow responsibility and the overall human experience disappears.

I am one person.

I have lived these circumstances as one connected history.

And I insist that the human consequences remain visible.

9. NSW Trustee & Guardian, the Public Guardian and NCAT

My dealings with NSW Trustee & Guardian and the Public Guardian form part of the documentary history I have preserved.

My account includes correspondence concerning an offer of an additional $100 per week, alongside the position that my full pension meant no further funding was available and that the agency did not source accommodation.

I have also sought assistance with an electricity bill of approximately $200.

Those figures may appear small on paper to someone with financial security.

They are not small to a person trying to keep the lights on, maintain communication and find somewhere safe to live.

An explanation of funding boundaries does not make an electricity bill disappear. A statement that an organisation does not source accommodation does not provide a home.

My history also includes a Public Guardian review through the NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal, or NCAT, in October 2025.

I regard these matters as part of a wider question of autonomy, dignity, practical

support and the consequences of administrative decisions for an actual human life.

I refuse to be reduced to a file, a classification or an administrative problem.

I am a person with a history, an education, a body of work, a documentary record and my own account of what I have experienced.

The relevant correspondence and review material should be read together, in context.

Repository starting point: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

Original archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

10. Legal Aid and the Denial of Effective Assistance

My history includes Legal Aid refusals and restrictions.

I have sought assistance in circumstances in which I believed I needed meaningful support to understand and pursue matters affecting my life.

I have also described the difficulty of challenging decisions made by people and organisations with far greater resources than I possessed.

The difference between having a theoretical right to pursue a matter and having the practical means to do so can be enormous.

A person may have documents but lack the assistance needed to organise them. A person may have a complaint but struggle to identify the appropriate pathway. A person may have a detailed account but find that the account must be repeatedly condensed, reframed and resubmitted to different offices.

I believe those barriers contributed to my sense of powerlessness.

I refuse to let the difficulty of obtaining assistance erase the substance of my testimony.

The history of seeking help is itself part of the history.

11. Hospitals, Psychiatry and the Right to Be Heard

I have described sixteen psychiatric hospitalisations across my history, together with

experiences of treatment that I regarded as coercive, including injections and what I experienced as chemical restraint.

These are serious and deeply personal matters.

I believe they must be understood in the context of my wider life, my efforts to communicate my concerns, and the consequences I have experienced.

I refuse to pretend that these experiences are insignificant simply because they occurred within healthcare institutions.

I also refuse to accept that a psychiatric history should be used as a shortcut for dismissing everything else I say.

I have academic work. I have creative work. I have professional experience. I have faith. I have correspondence, research and documentary material. I have a life extending far beyond any particular episode of distress or hospitalisation.

I am entitled to describe what I experienced and preserve the records relevant to that account.

My testimony does not require me to pretend that I was never unwell. It requires people to recognise that illness and distress do not erase personhood, intellectual capacity, moral agency or the right to be treated with dignity.

I believe my recovery has enabled me to examine my history with renewed determination.

I will not be reduced to a diagnosis.

I will not be reduced to a hospital file.

I will not be reduced to the assumptions other people may have formed about me.

I am the witness who lived through those experiences, and I retain the right to describe their meaning in my own words.

12. The NDIS Commission, Comcare and the Employment Question

My documentary history includes a Comcare refusal dated 26 May 2021 concerning the question of my employee status under section 5 of the *Safety, Rehabilitation and*

***Compensation Act*.**

It also includes correspondence from the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission dated 3 June 2021 concerning my employment status.

I have referred to a January 2024 Federal Court-related letter from Scott Treadwell, which I understand to support my position concerning employment by the Department of Social Services.

I believe these records are important to the employment-status and workers' compensation questions I have been trying to resolve.

The dates, wording, statutory context and relationship between the documents matter. I want the original records examined together rather than reduced to isolated statements.

My frustration is that I have had to keep track of complex correspondence and competing institutional positions while living with the practical consequences of my circumstances.

The records are part of a larger chronology. They do not exist in a vacuum.

My archive also includes financial and employment-related material concerning AustralianSuper, the Australian Financial Complaints Authority, WorkSafe and DXC. I want those records read on their own terms and in the context of the broader history I have documented.

I am not claiming that the existence of these records automatically establishes every conclusion I draw from them. I am insisting that they be preserved, connected and examined rather than scattered across disconnected processes.

13. Freedom of Information: The Paper Trail

My archive records my efforts to obtain government-held records through Freedom of Information processes.

These include PM&C FOI/2022/045, an initial response indicating that no documents were held, and a revised response dated 8 October 2024 that released five documents.

My records also include OAIC reference RQ22/00794 and correspondence concerning approximately 1,187 PM&C Outlook items under review.

I preserve these details because the history of what was searched, what was held, what was released and what was communicated matters to my understanding of the events.

These are not merely administrative numbers to me.

They represent years of trying to understand a documentary history and establish what records exist.

I should not have to become an archivist, investigator, indexer and preservation specialist simply to keep track of a history I have spent years trying to explain.

But that is part of what I have done.

I have retained the references. I have preserved the correspondence. I have tried to keep the chronology visible.

I refuse to let procedural complexity make the record practically inaccessible.

The paper trail is part of my testimony.

And I refuse to let the paper trail be buried.

14. The Prime Minister's Office and the Attorney-General's Department

My archive includes a note associated with the office of Prime Minister Anthony Albanese dated 12 December 2022, stating that my email had not been forwarded.

It also includes Attorney-General's Department correspondence dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, concerning referrals to the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security and the Commonwealth Ombudsman.

A further Attorney-General's Department reference, MC25-000321, dated 6 February 2025, concerns a referral to the Victorian Minister for Police.

I have preserved these records because they document attempts to bring my concerns to public offices and pursue answers through available channels.

I refuse to let the act of forwarding correspondence become the end of the story.

A referral is a step in an administrative process. It does not, by itself, resolve the

substance of the concern. An acknowledgement is evidence that communication occurred. It is not necessarily evidence that the person seeking assistance received the help they needed.

The person who raises a concern does not stop existing when the matter is referred.

The circumstances do not disappear.

The practical consequences do not vanish.

I want the correspondence read in sequence: what I raised, when I raised it, what the office communicated and what followed.

The prestige of a political office does not make its correspondence immune from examination.

15. The Commonwealth Ombudsman, IBAC, ICAC and IGIS

My documentary history includes a Commonwealth Ombudsman service-restriction letter dated 8 August 2025.

I experienced that restriction as another serious barrier in my prolonged efforts to obtain answers through official channels.

I was still the person living with the consequences. I was still the person preserving the evidence. I was still the person trying to make sense of the history.

I have also pursued accountability through pathways associated with integrity bodies, including IBAC, ICAC and the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security, or IGIS.

I want the submissions, complaints, referrals and responses preserved in their actual sequence.

I distinguish between submitting a complaint, receiving a response, being referred elsewhere and obtaining a substantive answer. Those are different events.

I do not claim that the mere existence of a complaint establishes wrongdoing by the organisation complained about. I am saying that the history of my attempts to pursue accountability should remain visible and that the underlying material deserves to be read in context.

A reference number is not an explanation.

A referral is not necessarily a resolution.

A closed pathway does not erase the chronology that preceded it.

My experience has made me question what protection means when the person seeking it remains responsible for carrying the consequences.

16. Human Rights, Disability and the Duty of Protection

I have pursued human-rights-related avenues, including correspondence with the Australian Human Rights Commission and material associated with international human-rights pathways and the United Nations.

My archive references the United Nations-related matter UR/UST/23/AUS/17.

I have also approached disability-related systems, advocacy organisations and services whose public purposes include protection, inclusion, recovery and support.

I believe my circumstances raise serious questions about the difference between declaring a commitment to human dignity and delivering meaningful assistance to a person who is struggling.

Human rights are not meaningful to a person merely because an organisation can describe them in a policy document.

Protection is not meaningful simply because an institution has a mandate.

Inclusion is not meaningful if the person whose life is being discussed feels excluded from the decisions that affect him.

And lived experience is not meaningful if it is welcomed when useful to an organisation's public mission but ignored when the person needs practical support.

I want the correspondence preserved. I want the chronology maintained. I want the distinction between what I requested, what was communicated and what happened next to remain clear.

I refuse to let the language of human rights become ceremonial vocabulary that sounds impressive in public while the person seeking help remains unheard.

PART IV — THE WIDER NETWORK OF RESPONSIBILITY

17. Whistleblowing and the Price of Speaking

Whistleblowing is praised when it is convenient.

Institutions speak about integrity, transparency, accountability and the importance of exposing wrongdoing.

But what happens to the person who continues living after the disclosure, the complaint, the correspondence and the public silence?

What happens when the whistleblower still needs housing, income, support and the ability to communicate?

What happens when the work of preserving evidence consumes the time and energy needed to rebuild a life?

I have spent years documenting matters that I believe deserve public attention. I have continued preserving records when the work has been exhausting and my practical circumstances have been difficult.

I have experienced isolation and exclusion while trying to maintain the documentary history.

I have repeatedly had to explain the relationship between documents, events and the consequences I describe.

It is easy to celebrate a courageous whistleblower in the abstract.

It is harder to confront the human being who needs assistance after the disclosure has been made.

I refuse to let my story be celebrated in theory while the person telling it is ignored in practice.

My archive is not a substitute for the life I have had to rebuild. It is part of my attempt to preserve that life in documentary form.

18. Police-Related Records and the Statements Attributed to Others

My archive includes police-related material and statements attributed to people whose communications I have preserved.

Among the records I have described is a PDF containing messages attributed to Ben. I have said that the messages include statements concerning fear for his own safety, an incident described as a "close call", and an account attributed to police concerning an allegedly fabricated report.

I want the original messages, dates and wording preserved.

I also want the distinction maintained between what a person wrote, what I understood those words to mean and what can independently be established about the underlying events.

That distinction does not require me to erase serious statements from my testimony. It requires the source material to be read accurately and in context.

I have also referred to matters involving police-related concerns, the Victorian Minister for Police referral and other correspondence preserved in my archive.

I want readers to examine the documents rather than rely solely on my summary or anyone else's characterisation.

I am not asking anyone to accept an allegation merely because it appears in my testimony. I am insisting that the material I have preserved be accessible and that the human consequences I describe not be dismissed without engagement.

19. Disability Services, SANE Australia and the Asylum Seekers Resource Centre

My dealings with disability services and support organisations form part of the wider history.

I have described an experience with SANE Australia in which I felt that my work and lived experience were welcomed and praised, but that I was ultimately left without the meaningful support I needed.

I regard that contrast as deeply disappointing.

I have also described approaching the Asylum Seekers Resource Centre in circumstances where I sought assistance and felt that I did not receive the practical

help I needed.

I understand that organisations have defined services, eligibility requirements and limitations. But those limitations do not erase the experience of a person who approaches for help and leaves feeling unsupported.

Public commitments to compassion mean little to the person who needs assistance if the practical result is that the person continues carrying the burden alone.

I want the relevant communications and chronology preserved so readers can understand what occurred, what was said and how I experienced the outcome.

I refuse to be treated as useful when my story illustrates an organisation's mission and inconvenient when I need sustained practical assistance.

Lived experience belongs to a living human being.

It is not a slogan.

It is not a marketing resource.

And it should not become a substitute for helping the person who has lived it.

20. Victoria University, My Research and My Intellectual Work

I hold a PhD from Victoria University, awarded in 2020.

I have expressed serious concerns about the treatment, recognition and presentation of my research. I believe aspects of my work have been diminished or delegitimised in the broader history I have documented.

My academic history does not make me infallible. It does mean that my work should be engaged with as work: read, understood, questioned and discussed on its substance.

I refuse to let my psychiatric history become a shortcut for dismissing everything I have researched, written or documented.

I want the methods, evidence, reasoning and arguments to remain visible.

My intellectual work is part of my history. It is part of the person telling this story. It cannot be understood solely through the assumptions someone else may have formed

about me.

21. Galleries, Curators, the DAX Collection and My Creative Work

I have raised concerns about the use, presentation and interpretation of my creative work, including matters involving galleries, curators and the DAX Collection.

My objection is not to discussing mental health in art. My objection is to the possibility that my work may be reduced to a psychiatric category in a way that, in my view, diminishes the wider context of my life and creative practice.

I am more than a diagnosis.

I am more than a hospital history.

I am more than a story about madness.

I am a person with an intellectual history, professional experience, creative work, research, writing, faith and a documentary archive.

Art is not detached from the human being who creates it.

A gallery wall does not make an interpretation neutral. A catalogue entry does not exhaust an artist's history. A collection does not give other people the final word on the person whose work they hold.

Where I believe my work has been treated unfairly, I want the relevant artwork records, publications, correspondence and curatorial material preserved and read in context.

I refuse to have my voice disappear behind somebody else's interpretation of my work.

22. Allen & Unwin, Publishing and the Media

Allen & Unwin published my book *Recovered, Not Cured* in 2003.

That publication forms part of my professional history and my longstanding engagement with questions of recovery, mental health and lived experience.

I have since expressed profound frustration about my efforts to bring attention to a wider story that I regard as important, and about my experience of not securing the publishing engagement or media coverage I sought.

I have worked in media and visual communication. I understand the importance of public storytelling, documentary evidence and the ability to communicate complicated matters clearly.

I have preserved material because I believe the history deserves examination, not because I expect every journalist or publisher to agree with my interpretation.

I refuse to accept that a story becomes unworthy of examination merely because it is complicated, difficult to summarise or challenging to fit into a conventional news cycle.

When I could not secure the platform I sought, I continued preserving the documents.

When the story could not find the audience I hoped for, I continued writing.

When I could not rely on a publisher to carry the whole history, I worked to make the material accessible myself.

My evidence is not dependent on a publisher's permission to exist.

My voice is not dependent on a newsroom deciding that my story is convenient.

I cannot compel a journalist to publish my testimony. But I can preserve the record, make it accessible and explain why I believe it matters.

I will not mistake media silence for proof that my history has nothing to say.

23. Politicians, Ministers and Public Offices

I have approached politicians, ministers, government departments and public offices because I believed my circumstances deserved attention.

My archive includes correspondence associated with the office of Prime Minister Anthony Albanese, the Attorney-General's Department and the referral to the Victorian Minister for Police.

It also contains records relevant to oversight bodies, disability-related systems, financial processes and human-rights-related pathways.

I am angry about the experience of trying to bring a serious history to the attention of people and offices associated with public responsibility while continuing to live with the

consequences myself.

Public office carries responsibilities.

Professional status carries responsibilities.

A mandate to protect vulnerable people carries responsibilities.

Those responsibilities do not disappear because a matter is complicated, politically uncomfortable or difficult to allocate to a particular office.

I want the correspondence read. I want the chronology understood. I want the sequence preserved.

I will not pretend that my experience has been satisfactory simply because an office has replied.

24. Financial Institutions, AustralianSuper, AFCA, WorkSafe and DXC

My documentary history includes financial and employment-related matters concerning AustralianSuper, the Australian Financial Complaints Authority, WorkSafe, DXC and associated processes.

These matters form part of the broader history I have been trying to assemble concerning employment status, claims, administrative decisions and the financial consequences I have experienced.

My records also refer to the CDDC scheme and associated financial and administrative processes.

I want these matters examined on their own terms and in the context of the wider chronology.

Financial questions cannot always be understood in isolation from housing insecurity, access to assistance, employment questions and the practical consequences of prolonged uncertainty.

I refuse to let each process be considered so narrowly that the relationship between the records disappears.

I am the person who has had to connect them.

I am the person who has had to preserve the chronology.

I am the person who has had to live with the consequences while trying to understand what the documents mean.

That work is part of my testimony.

25. Names, People and the Duty to Preserve Context

My documentary history also contains references to individuals, workers, professionals and other people whose names appear in correspondence or in my account of events. These include names I have previously identified as Parkes and Linster, as well as Able Point, Wyong Court, Suki Tia, Bill Shorten, Philip Glass in connection with the Public Guardian material, Commonwealth Bank, Rachael, and workers or other individuals identified as Ash, Ben, John, Kim, Cass, Danny, Daniel and Alissi.

I want these names and references treated as documentary leads, not as a substitute for evidence.

Where a person's name appears in a source document, the reader should be able to see the original context, the date, the exact wording and the relationship of that record to my account.

Where I have made an allegation about a person's conduct, it should be understood as my allegation unless the source establishes something more.

Where a document records what someone said, the words should not be silently transformed into proof of every event surrounding them.

I will not erase names or relationships from the history merely because the material is difficult. But neither will I invent details about people or assign them responsibility that the documents do not establish.

The point is not to create a list of villains.

The point is to preserve the record of who communicated, who made decisions, which organisations were involved and what happened next.

Accountability requires context.

My testimony requires the freedom to describe what I experienced.

And the archive must preserve the distinction between those two things.

PART V — THE DOCUMENTARY RECORD

26. The Evidence Is Now in the Public Domain

My testimony and documentary archive are publicly accessible.

The original public archive is available at:

https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

The rebuilt preservation site is available at:

https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

The primary GitHub evidence repository is available at:

https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

The rebuild source repository is available at:

https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild

The original index file is available at:

https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/index.html

The preservation project includes a site index described as covering 660 pages, together with website pages, PDFs, links and preservation records. The original repository includes a backup structure organised into HTML, PDF and link material, alongside files such as a manifest and URL list.

The rebuild is a separate effort to make the material accessible without altering the original archive.

I have worked to preserve the record because I refuse to let my experiences be erased, forgotten or reduced to a label attached to my name.

I want readers to be able to move between my account and the documents I have collected.

I want them to follow the chronology, read the correspondence, examine the decisions and understand the human consequences.

I do not claim that every allegation is established merely because I have published it. I am saying that my testimony exists, the documents exist, and the underlying records should be read in their actual context.

I believe the material raises serious questions about professional conduct, institutional accountability, the exercise of public power and the treatment of a vulnerable person who has continued trying to obtain answers.

The archive is a finding aid as well as a testimony.

It is a record of the work I have undertaken to keep my history visible.

27. Preservation, Hashes and the Refusal to Let the Record Disappear

My preservation work is itself part of this history.

I have worked to organise the documentary material, maintain the index, preserve copies of website content and make the record accessible through GitHub.

The preservation project includes an archive index described as containing 660 pages, as well as HTML pages, PDFs, links, a manifest and URL records.

I have also recorded a SHA-256 hash for the PDF titled *The Witness Remains: The Paradox of Protection — The Barran Dodger Public Testimony, Documentary Record and Evidence Index*:

4ae475ec092b56e53212368bf3d3ce9c24446bc9477e4564e46860be8985799c

The recorded file size was 210.9 kB. An OpenTimestamps receipt was created, with a download initiated.

A SHA-256 hash is a digital fingerprint of a particular file. It can help establish whether a later copy matches the file that was hashed. An OpenTimestamps receipt can provide

evidence relevant to when a particular hash was submitted to the timestamping system. These technical records do not, by themselves, establish the truth of every statement within a document. They are part of my effort to preserve the identity and history of the material.

I have done this because the documentary record matters to me.

I have tried to preserve what I could, organise it coherently and make it possible for readers to follow the trail.

I refuse to let my life disappear because an institution has moved on, a website has changed, a complaint pathway has closed or a person would prefer not to revisit the past.

The record is not the whole of my life.

But it is part of the history I have worked to preserve.

28. How I Want Readers to Follow the Record

I want readers to distinguish between three things.

First, there is my first-person testimony: what I remember, what I experienced, what I believe happened and how I understand the consequences.

Second, there are documentary records: correspondence, official letters, reference numbers, decisions, emails, publications and other source material.

Third, there are the conclusions I draw from bringing the testimony and records together.

Those three things are connected, but they are not interchangeable.

A letter can establish what an office communicated. It does not automatically establish every motive I attribute to the person who sent it.

A referral can establish that a matter was referred. It does not automatically establish that the underlying concern was resolved.

A document can support a chronology without proving every inference I draw from it.

And a limitation in one record does not make my entire life disappear.

I want the source material read carefully. I want the chronology maintained. I want the documents linked to their exact locations wherever those locations can be verified.

The original repository is the starting point for that work:

https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

The rebuilt site is another route into the preserved material:

https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

I will not invent filenames or pretend that a general repository link leads directly to a particular letter when that exact file path has not been verified.

I want the evidence accessible because I believe the truth deserves to be examined, not because I need to make every reader reach the same conclusion.

I am preserving the record.

I am telling my story.

And I am refusing to disappear.

PART VI — THE DIVINE RECKONING

29. My Faith, My Conscience and the Examination of the Soul

There is another investigation that I believe has been happening throughout my life: the examination of the soul before God.

I believe in God the Creator.

I believe His grace sustained me through betrayal, poverty, isolation, distress and loss.

I believe I was given the strength to survive circumstances that I feared might destroy me.

And I believe I have been given the opportunity to tell my story and preserve the evidence I have collected.

My faith is not an ornament attached to the end of my testimony. It is part of the way I understand my survival.

I believe that every person carries a conscience, an inner capacity to recognise the difference between right and wrong. I believe that conscience matters most when the truth is inconvenient, when doing the right thing carries a cost, and when a person must decide whether to stand independently or hide behind the protection of a group.

You can explain your decisions.

You can point to policies.

You can say you were following instructions.

You can say another office was responsible.

You can say that you acted within a procedure.

But none of those statements automatically answers the moral question.

Did you treat another human being with dignity?

Did you exercise independent judgment?

Did you consider the consequences of your decisions?

Did you listen when someone tried to explain that they were suffering?

Did you examine the evidence, or did you accept the version of events that was easiest for you?

Did you act according to the ethical obligations attached to your position?

And when you had an opportunity to reconsider, did you take it?

These are questions of conscience.

If you believe in God, I invite you to read the Bible and undertake serious soul-searching. Stand before a mirror. Put aside your title, your salary, your institutional position and the reassuring voices of colleagues who may share your assumptions.

Ask yourself whether you acted with compassion.

Ask yourself whether you acted honestly.

Ask yourself whether you took responsibility.

Ask yourself whether you would have made the same decisions if you had been the person without a home, without legal assistance, without financial security and without the means to defend yourself effectively.

Ask yourself whether you would have accepted the same treatment for someone you loved.

I do not claim to know what God will judge in any individual soul. I do not claim to speak for God or to control divine judgment.

I am saying that I believe no human being can make a title, a policy or an institutional alliance a substitute for conscience.

I believe divine reckoning begins when we stop hiding from the truth about ourselves.

30. The Sin of Selling Out Your Own Integrity

What I believe is most disturbing about the paradox of protection is the possibility that people can become so accustomed to the system around them that they stop examining the consequences of their participation.

They become comfortable.

They become accustomed to the language.

They become accustomed to the hierarchy.

They learn which questions are inconvenient and which explanations are accepted.

They learn how to refer a matter elsewhere, how to describe a concern in a narrow category and how to keep moving through the working day.

And somewhere in that process, the person at the centre of the matter can disappear.

I believe I experienced the consequences of that kind of institutional fragmentation.

I believe some of the conduct I encountered was inconsistent with the ethical obligations attached to the positions of those involved.

I believe there were occasions when a more humane, independent and careful response was possible.

I believe some opportunities to reconsider were missed.

But I cannot know what every person privately understood or intended. That is why I have preserved the documents and the chronology.

I want the conduct examined against the obligations that existed at the time.

A title does not guarantee integrity.

A salary does not establish merit.

A qualification does not automatically make someone humane.

A government position does not excuse conduct that harms another person.

And a group of colleagues agreeing with one another does not make a decision morally right.

If you believe you acted honourably, then examine the record.

If you believe you acted correctly, then explain the decisions.

If you believe you fulfilled your obligations, then confront the difference between what those obligations required and what I experienced.

That is not a demand that you accept every accusation I make.

It is a demand that professional responsibility mean something.

I believe the deepest humiliation is not being asked a difficult question.

It is discovering that you have failed to become the person you believed yourself to be.

31. You Thought the Record Would Never Escape Containment

I believe the history I have described was easier to ignore when it existed as disconnected correspondence, private recollections, administrative references and fragments of a story that I was struggling to communicate.

One letter here.

One decision there.

One office explaining its jurisdiction.

Another office issuing a response.

Another process reaching a limit.

Meanwhile, I was still living with the consequences.

I believe that fragmentation made it difficult to see the cumulative effect of the history as I experienced it.

But I began preserving the record.

I organised the documents.

I created an index.

I kept the chronology.

I worked on the archive.

I rebuilt the site separately so that the original archive could remain distinct from the preservation project.

I published my testimony.

I used digital preservation methods to record file identities and preserve the material as best I could.

I cannot know what any individual expected would happen to these records. But I can say that I no longer accept the idea that my history should remain inaccessible simply

because it is complicated.

The record is public.

The archive exists.

The testimony exists.

The person who lived through the history is still here.

I believe that this is a profound contradiction for anyone who assumed that I would remain permanently silenced or that the documentary trail would never become intelligible to other people.

I have made no claim that every page independently proves every conclusion I draw. I have made the material available so that the distinction between documents, testimony and interpretation can be examined.

I believe the public record exposes the gap between the protection institutions promise and the vulnerability I experienced.

And I believe that gap deserves serious attention.

32. The Embarrassment of Refusing to Grow

I have had to change.

I have had to confront myself.

I have had to examine my mistakes, my regrets, my beliefs and the ways I understand my own history.

I have had to learn how to continue living without allowing the past to dictate every possibility in my future.

I have had to find ways to rebuild.

That work has not made me perfect. It has made me more determined to live honestly.

I believe that anyone who has exercised responsibility over another person's life should be willing to undertake a similar examination of their own conduct.

Growth requires the willingness to reconsider.

Integrity requires the willingness to admit error.

Compassion requires the willingness to recognise another person's humanity.

And accountability requires the willingness to look beyond the comfort of one's own explanation.

I cannot know whether the people involved have reflected on their actions. I cannot know whether they feel guilt, shame, regret or nothing at all.

But I can say this: refusing to examine oneself is a way of remaining trapped in the same assumptions that produced the original harm.

If you have made a mistake, acknowledge it.

If you have misunderstood a person, reconsider.

If you have acted contrary to your obligations, take responsibility.

If you believe you did nothing wrong, explain your reasoning honestly and allow the record to be examined.

What I reject is stagnation disguised as certainty.

I reject the idea that professional status removes the need for personal growth.

I reject the notion that a person can preserve an image of integrity indefinitely while refusing to examine the consequences of their conduct.

I have had to grow beyond the circumstances in which I was left.

I will not apologise for that growth.

And I will not remain trapped in the version of myself that you may have found easiest to dismiss.

33. I Never Intended to Harm You

I want to make something clear.

I never intended to harm you.

I did not set out to destroy your life.

I did not ask for your suffering.

I did not ask to be placed in conflict with you.

I wanted to be treated with dignity, courtesy and respect. I wanted people in positions of responsibility to exercise their obligations honestly. I wanted the opportunity to explain my circumstances and have the documents considered in context.

I believe I was let down by people and institutions from whom I sought protection.

I believe some decisions caused me serious detriment.

I believe some conduct I experienced was deliberate, malicious or inconsistent with the obligations attached to the positions of those involved.

But I do not need to destroy you to establish my humanity.

I do not need to threaten you to demand accountability.

I do not need to wish suffering upon you to explain the seriousness of what I believe happened.

If I have harmed anyone, I have tried to acknowledge my mistakes and regrets publicly. I have written about my failings. I have owned them. I have sought peace with myself and with God.

I have offered opportunities to reconsider.

I have tried to explain.

I have tried to communicate.

I have tried to make the history understood.

I have not received the acknowledgement or accountability I sought in the

circumstances I describe.

That is why I am moving forward without waiting for an apology.

I do not need an apology in order to exist.

I do not need your permission to heal.

I do not need your acknowledgement in order to preserve my testimony.

And I do not need your approval to continue living my life.

I leave each person responsible for examining their own conscience.

I leave the documents available for examination.

And I leave divine judgment to God.

34. The Reckoning Is Not Mine to Control

I believe that accountability is larger than the immediate outcome of a dispute.

There may be public scrutiny. There may be professional examination. There may be questions about decisions, correspondence and the exercise of authority. There may be conversations among colleagues, friends, family members and the wider community.

I cannot determine in advance what any particular process will conclude.

I cannot promise that any particular person will be arrested, convicted, fined or imprisoned.

But the absence of a particular legal outcome would not erase my experience, invalidate the existence of my testimony or make the documentary record disappear.

My faith teaches me that how we treat vulnerable people matters.

I believe conscience matters.

I believe integrity matters.

I believe honesty matters.

I believe the way we exercise power reveals something fundamental about who we are.

I do not need revenge.

I do not need to wish suffering upon anyone.

I do not need to become the person I believe harmed me.

I need to continue living, continue healing, continue preserving the record and continue speaking honestly about what I experienced.

I believe the consequences of our choices must be confronted in whatever form accountability ultimately takes.

That is not something I need to manufacture.

I have offered grace.

I have offered opportunities to reconsider.

I have tried to explain my circumstances.

I will no longer allow my silence to be mistaken for defeat.

PART VII — I WILL RISE

35. You Thought I Would Remain in the Ashes

You thought you could leave me in the ashes of my life.

You thought I would remain isolated, impoverished, forgotten and unable to recover.

You thought the circumstances through which I struggled would become the permanent boundaries of my existence.

You thought I would remain a footnote in your story.

But I am still here.

I am rebuilding myself.

I am healing.

I am learning.

I am continuing to work.

I am preserving the documentary record.

I have my testimony.

I have my faith.

I have my conscience.

I have the evidence I have worked to preserve.

I have admitted my mistakes. I have confronted my regrets. I have tried to make peace with my past.

I have grown beyond the need to prove my worth to people who treated me as though I had none.

I do not need to destroy you to establish my humanity.

I do not need to humiliate you to demonstrate that I survived.

I do not need to control your future to reclaim mine.

I will continue to exist.

I will continue to speak.

I will continue to preserve the evidence.

I will continue to make my testimony available.

I believe God sustained me for a reason, and I intend to use the life I have been given to bear witness to what I experienced.

You may disagree with my interpretation.

You may reject my allegations.

You may choose not to read my testimony.

But you cannot make my life disappear by refusing to acknowledge it.

You cannot erase the fact that I survived.

You cannot take away the years I have spent documenting what happened.

You cannot make me surrender the dignity that belongs to me as a human being.

My story did not end where I believe you thought it would.

My life did not stop at the point of my greatest distress.

My future did not belong to the assumptions you made about me.

I am still becoming.

I am still rebuilding.

I am still here.

36. The Witness Is No Longer a Footnote

For years, I have felt that other people, institutions and administrative processes had the power to define the circumstances of my life without fully engaging with the person living through them.

I refuse to surrender authorship of my own testimony.

I am not a throwaway story.

I am not a disposable human being.

I am not a footnote that can be removed whenever my existence becomes inconvenient.

I am the author of my testimony.

I am the person who lived through the circumstances I describe.

I am the person who collected the documents, preserved the chronology and continued speaking.

I have no need to invent a different life to make my testimony compelling.

My survival, my mistakes, my regrets, my faith, my research and my documentary record are all part of the history I am preserving.

I believe the treatment I experienced deserves serious scrutiny. I believe the decisions made about me deserve to be examined. I believe people entrusted with professional responsibility should confront the ethical obligations attached to their positions.

I do not need to wish harm upon anyone to say that.

I do not need to threaten anyone to demand accountability.

I simply refuse to disappear.

The documents will remain available. The testimony will remain part of the public record. My account will not be erased simply because someone would prefer not to hear it.

You thought I was beneath you.

You underestimated me.

You thought I would never rise beyond the cage.

You did not know my potential.

You did not know how much I would continue to learn, how much I would preserve or how determined I would become to tell my own story.

I am no longer waiting for someone else to write the ending.

37. The Final Reckoning: Examine Your Own Soul

To every person who occupied a position of responsibility in the history I have described, I leave this challenge.

Examine your own words.

Examine your own decisions.

Examine your own correspondence.

Examine the obligations attached to your position.

Examine what you knew at the time.

Examine what you were told.

Examine what you did in response.

Examine what happened to the person who had to live with the consequences.

Do not hide behind a title.

Do not hide behind a salary.

Do not hide behind a colleague.

Do not hide behind a policy.

Do not hide behind the convenient explanation that responsibility belonged somewhere else.

If you believe you acted with integrity, then examine the record and explain your decisions.

If you believe you fulfilled your obligations, then consider the human consequences and the standards you were required to uphold.

If you believe you made mistakes, then have the courage to acknowledge them.

And if you discover that you did not act as honourably as you once believed, have the courage to grow.

I cannot make you feel guilt.

I cannot compel you to experience shame.

I cannot decide what you will see when you examine your own conscience.

But I can refuse to carry the entire burden of this history in silence.

I can preserve the documents.

I can tell my story.

I can explain why I believe the conduct I experienced was wrong.

I can leave the record accessible to other people.

And I can continue living without waiting for you to acknowledge my humanity.

I believe divine reckoning begins with the moment a person can no longer avoid the question of whether they acted according to their own professed values.

I believe that the examination of conscience is more demanding than the defence of reputation.

And I believe that no institution, no alliance and no professional title can replace the responsibility each of us carries for our own conduct.

I leave that examination to you.

I leave the judgment of souls to God.

I leave the documentary record open to examination.

And I leave my testimony in the public domain.

PART VIII — MY FINAL STATEMENT

38. The Witness Remains

I did not give you permission to harm me.

I did not give you permission to treat me as less than human.

I did not give you permission to abandon the ethical responsibilities attached to your position.

I did not give you permission to decide that my suffering did not matter.

I believe I was betrayed by people and institutions from whom I sought protection. I believe decisions were made that caused me serious detriment. I believe some of the conduct I experienced was deliberate, malicious or inconsistent with the obligations attached to the positions of those involved.

I have preserved my account and the evidence I have collected.

I have published my testimony in the public domain.

I have acknowledged my own mistakes and regrets.

I have continued to seek truth, accountability and justice.

I have survived periods of profound distress.

I have continued to rebuild.

I have refused to let my psychiatric history become the whole story of my life.

I have refused to let poverty, isolation, housing insecurity and exhaustion extinguish my voice.

I am not asking for permission to exist.

I am not asking to be made whole by the people I believe harmed me.

I am not waiting for an apology before I move forward.

My faith in God has sustained me.

My conscience is my own.

My testimony is my own.

My life is my own.

I believe God protected me and gave me the strength to survive. I believe I have been given the opportunity to speak when I might otherwise have remained unheard.

I leave divine judgment to God.

I leave the documentary record open to examination.

I leave my testimony in the public domain.

And I will continue to live.

I will continue to heal.

I will continue to speak.

I will continue to rise from the ashes of the circumstances in which I was left.

You thought my story would end in silence.

It did not.

You thought I would never rise beyond the cage.

I did.

You thought I would remain a footnote.

I am writing my own testimony.

You thought the record would remain fragmented and inaccessible.

I have worked to preserve it.

You thought my vulnerability meant I had no strength left.

You were wrong.

I am Dr Richard William McLean.

I am Barran Dodger.

I am the witness who survived.

I am the person who has continued to rebuild.

I am the person who has preserved this record.

And I am still here.

THE WITNESS REMAINS.

THE RECORD REMAINS.

TRUTH DOES NOT NEED PERMISSION TO EXIST.

LIES NEED CONSTANT UPKEEP.

MY TRUTH NEEDED TIME.

BY GOD'S GRACE, I AM STILL HERE.

YOU ARE NO LONGER THE AUTHOR OF MY STORY.

———

THE ARCHIVE — START HERE

Original documentary archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/

Rebuilt preservation archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

Primary GitHub evidence repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

Rebuild source repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild

Original archive index: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/index.html

The archive is intended to help readers locate and examine the documentary material underlying my testimony. The repository contains the starting point for the preservation project and its organised website, PDF and link material.

Where a particular letter, report, email or PDF has not yet been connected to an

individually verified file URL, the repository above is the starting point for locating it. No unverified document address is represented here as though it were a confirmed direct link.

This testimony records my account, my interpretation and the human consequences I describe. The source documents should be read in their original context, with their dates and wording preserved. My allegations remain my allegations unless a particular source independently establishes more.

I have preserved this history because I believe it matters.

I have made it public because I refuse to disappear.

THE WITNESS REMAINS. THE RECORD REMAINS.